

Redmi Note 14 Pro

A note-worthy upgrade?

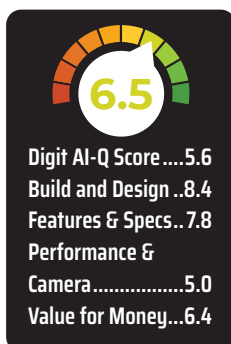
Xiaomi recently launched its Redmi Note 14 series in India which attempts to follow in the footsteps of its beloved predecessors, however, concerns about the rising prices of the Redmi Note series are afloat in the tech space. I got the Redmi Note 14 Pro for review, which at its ₹24,999 price point, seems like a very interesting mid-range option. While it offers premium features like IP68 dust and water resistance, Gorilla Glass Victus 2 protection, and a large 5,500 mAh Silicon Carbon battery, competitors like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo and OnePlus Nord CE4 rear their heads, challenging the Note 14 series' dominance in the space. Will the Redmi Note 14 Pro be enough to entice Indian consumers or will the competition prevail? Let's find out in my detailed Redmi Note 14 Pro review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

With a svelte design, the Redmi Note 14 Pro stands out amidst the crowd at first glance. The curved body, the textured leather back panel, and the distinctive squircle camera module are instantly eye-catching. The leather back panel on my Phantom Purple review unit features a colour block design with shades of lavender adorning the four segmentations which looks pretty neat. The Ivy Green variant also follows a similar design language, but the Titan Black variant sports a single colour on the back.

The leather rear panel, while stylish, feels slightly rough to the touch, especially compared to the softer in-hand feel of Motorola's Edge 50 Fusion. That said, with a thickness of 8.4 mm and a weight of 190g, the phone offers a comfortable grip and excellent weight distribution. The glass camera module adds a unique visual contrast, enhancing the overall design.

The Redmi Note 14 Pro's frame may be made of plastic, but it convincingly



mimics the look of premium metal. The buttons offer satisfying tactile feedback, and the optical in-display fingerprint sensor impresses with its accuracy. The vibration motor isn't the best though.

While the display bezels aren't perfectly even, they remain slim for the most part. Xiaomi has struck an excellent balance with the design, making it eye-catching without pushing it to the point of being overdone.

As for durability, the Redmi Note 14 Pro is one of the best you can get at this price point. The phone comes with an IP68 dust and water resistance rating, which means it is fully dust-proof and the phone can be submerged up to 2 meters in water for 24 hours. Its predecessor only offered IP54. Additionally, at ₹25,000 where most phone brands compromise on display protection, Xiaomi is offering the industry-leading Gorilla Glass Victus 2 protection.

While it doesn't get MIL-STD-810H protection like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo, it makes up by offering Victus 2 where the Edge 50 Neo only offers the dated Gorilla Glass 3. All in all, the Redmi Note 14 Pro

is an exceptional upgrade when it comes to build and design, and is possibly one of the best-designed phones money can buy under ₹25,000.

DISPLAY

While the Redmi Note 14 Pro's display specifications remain largely unchanged as compared to its predecessor, this area does see one key improvement – brightness. The Note 14 Pro has the same 6.67-inch AMOLED display with a 1.5K resolution, 120 Hz refresh rate, and HDR10+ and Dolby Vision support. It is still a 12-bit display with support for 68 billion colours. The brightness, on the other hand, has been bumped up to 3,000 nits of peak brightness. However, the HBM brightness stays the same at 1,200 nits.

Now, even though there aren't many significant differences here, the display continues to be excellent for this price bracket. The colours are vivid, the display is sharp, and the viewing angles are fantastic. HDR content looks sublime with brilliant highlights and deep blacks. In my tests, the display touched 1,182 nits on High Brightness Mode, which is great, so sunlight legibility is amazing.

The Motorola Edge 50 Neo holds a slight edge in the display department, thanks to its support for LTPO technology. This enables it to seamlessly adjust its refresh rate between 1-120 Hz, enhancing battery efficiency. But the Redmi Note 14 Pro does edge out the OnePlus Nord CE4, as it only offers a 1080p display.

PERFORMANCE, SOFTWARE, AND AI

The Redmi Note 14 Pro steps up its performance game with the MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Ultra, a solid upgrade over the Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 powering its predecessor. With a peak clock speed of 2.5 GHz, it delivers noticeable speed improvements. That said, the RAM options see a slight downgrade, as the Note 14 Pro caps out at 8 GB, unlike the Note 13 Pro, which offered a 12 GB variant. On the storage front, you get 128 GB or 256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage.

Starting with synthetic benchmarks, the Redmi Note 14 Pro isn't the best performer. The OnePlus Nord CE4 and the